

Differential Geometry

Exercise 5

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5.1 Problem

Solve problem 6, page 78, of “Foundations of Lie Groups and Differentiable Manifolds”, Warner. Let X, Y be vector fields on M , with $p \in M$. Let θ, ψ be the flows of X, Y , and define

$$\beta(t) = \psi_{-\sqrt{t}}\theta_{-\sqrt{t}}\psi_{\sqrt{t}}\theta_{\sqrt{t}}(p)$$

in a neighborhood of 0, forming a curve. Show that for $f \in C^\infty(M)$,

$$[X, Y]_p f = \lim_{t \rightarrow 0} \frac{f(\beta(t)) - f(\beta(0))}{t}.$$

Since our limit is over $t > 0$ (considering the domain of square roots), it is equal to

$$\lim_{t \rightarrow 0} \frac{f(\beta(t^2)) - f(p)}{t^2}.$$

Our goal is to use L'Hôpital's rule to compute this limit (by continuity the numerator tends to zero). Let us define

$$\gamma(x, y, z, w) = f(\psi_{-x}\theta_{-y}\psi_z\theta_w(p)),$$

so that $f(\beta(t^2)) = \gamma(t, t, t, t)$. So to compute the derivative of $f(\beta(t^2))$ we compute the partial derivatives of γ .

We have the following situation: we want to differentiate a function of the form

$$h(t) = f \circ \theta_t \circ g(p)$$

where θ_t is the flow of some vector field X and f is real-valued. Then

$$h'(t) = df_{\theta_t(gp)}(\theta^{gp})'(t),$$

and since θ is the flow of X , this is equal to

$$h'(t) = df_{\theta_t(gp)}X_{\theta_t(gp)} = X_{\theta_t(gp)}f.$$

In our case, this gives us

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{\partial \gamma}{\partial x} &= -Y_{\psi_{-x}\theta_{-y}\psi_z\theta_w(p)}f \\ \frac{\partial \gamma}{\partial y} &= -X_{\theta_{-y}\psi_z\theta_w(p)}(f \circ \psi_{-x}) \\ \frac{\partial \gamma}{\partial z} &= Y_{\psi_z\theta_w(p)}(f\psi_{-x}\theta_{-y}) \\ \frac{\partial \gamma}{\partial w} &= X_{\theta_w(p)}(f\psi_{-x}\theta_{-y}\psi_z). \end{aligned}$$

Thus

$$f(\beta(t^2))'(0) = \sum_i \frac{\partial \gamma}{\partial x_i}(0) = -Y_p f - X_p f + Y_p f + X_p f = 0,$$

and so we can apply L'Hôpital again (the denominator is $2t$). But we need to differentiate these partial derivatives. These are functions of the form

$$k(t) = X_{h \circ \theta_t \circ f} g = (Xg)(h \circ \theta_t \circ f(p)).$$

where X is a vector field and θ is the flow of some other vector field Y , g some real-valued smooth function, and f, h some smooth functions. Then

$$k'(t) = d(Xg)_{h \circ \theta_t \circ f(p)} dh_{\theta_t \circ f(p)} (\theta^{f(p)})'(t) = d(Xg)_{h \circ \theta_t \circ f(p)} dh_{\theta_t \circ f(p)} Y_{\theta_t \circ f(p)} = Y((Xg) \circ h)_{\theta_t \circ f(p)}.$$

So we have (by symmetry of second-order partial derivatives):

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{\partial \gamma}{\partial xx} &= Y(Yf)_{\psi_{-x}\theta_{-y}\psi_z\theta_w(p)} \\ \frac{\partial \gamma}{\partial xy} &= X((Yf) \circ \psi_{-x})_{\theta_{-y}\psi_z\theta_w} \\ \frac{\partial \gamma}{\partial xz} &= -Y((Yf)\psi_{-x}\theta_{-y})_{\psi_z\theta_w} \\ \frac{\partial \gamma}{\partial xw} &= -X((Yf)\psi_{-x}\theta_{-y}\psi_z)_{\theta_w} \\ \frac{\partial \gamma}{\partial yy} &= X(X(f\psi_{-x}))_{\theta_{-y}\psi_z\theta_w} \\ \frac{\partial \gamma}{\partial yz} &= -Y(X(f\psi_{-x})\theta_{-y})_{\psi_z\theta_w} \\ \frac{\partial \gamma}{\partial yw} &= -X(X(f\psi_{-x})\theta_{-y}\psi_z)_{\theta_w} \\ \frac{\partial \gamma}{\partial zz} &= Y(Y(f\psi_{-x}\theta_{-y}))_{\psi_z\theta_w} \\ \frac{\partial \gamma}{\partial zw} &= X(Y(f\psi_{-x}\theta_{-y})\psi_z)_{\theta_w} \\ \frac{\partial \gamma}{\partial ww} &= X(X(f\psi_{-x}\theta_{-y}\psi_z))_{\theta_w}. \end{aligned}$$

So

$$f(\beta(t^2))''(0) = \sum_{i,j} \frac{\partial \gamma}{\partial x_i x_j}(0),$$

and evaluating the second order partial derivatives at 0 gives results like $Y_p Y f, X_p Y f$, etc. Then dividing by 2 (the denominator of the limit is 2, the second derivative of t^2) gives that the limit is equal to

$$X_p Y f - Y_p X f = [X, Y]_p f$$

as desired.

5.2 Problem

Prove that there is a unique smooth structure on $\mathbb{R}$ with its standard topology, up to diffeomorphism.

Let M be a smooth manifold over $\mathbb{R}$ with the same topology. Suppose that there is a nowhere vanishing vector field on M , call it X , and let $\gamma: I \rightarrow M$ be a maximal integral curve starting at 0. Then

$$\gamma'(t) = X_{\gamma(t)} \neq 0$$

means that $\gamma'(t)$ has full rank (one) always, and is thus a submersion and immersion. Furthermore integral curves are either periodic or injective; since γ has nonzero derivative it cannot be periodic, so it is injective.

Since γ is a submersion, it is an open map, so $\gamma(I) \subseteq M$ is open and connected. If γ is not surjective then $\gamma(I)$ is an open interval (a, b) with one side finite, assume b is. But then there is another integral curve of X starting at b , call it δ , and similarly its image in M is an open interval and thus intersects (a, b) . Let $\delta(s) \in (a, b)$ so that $p = \gamma(t) = \delta(s)$ for some t , and then $\gamma(x+t)$ and $\delta(x+s)$ are both integral curves starting at p , so they agree in their common domain. But then we can extend γ to part of δ 's domain, including b . This contradicts γ 's maximality, so γ 's image must be all of M .

Thus γ is bijective, an immersion, and a submersion. Thus it is a diffeomorphism, and since $I \subseteq \mathbb{R}$ is an open interval and thus diffeomorphic to $\mathbb{R}$, M and $\mathbb{R}$ are diffeomorphic.

Now we show that a nowhere vanishing X exists. Let us cover M by smooth charts on open intervals (a_i, b_i) , and by reordering and shrinking we can assume $a_i < b_{i-1} < a_{i+1} < b_i$ for all i (so every point is contained in at most two open sets). Furthermore, we can assume that this atlas is oriented: we start at $i = 0$ and work forward swapping orientation of the charts if they aren't compatible with the orientation of (a_0, b_0) 's chart. Similarly we work backward.

Now define the vector field X^i on (a_i, b_i) to be given by d/dt (relative to the chart). If we let τ^i be the transition function between (a_i, b_i) and (a_{i+1}, b_{i+1}) , then X_p^i relative to (a_{i+1}, b_{i+1}) is $(\tau_i)'d/dt$. Since the atlas is oriented, $(\tau_i)' > 0$.

Now let λ_i be a partition of unity subordinate to the open cover, and let

$$X = \sum_i \lambda_i X^i.$$

This is smooth by local finiteness, and thus forms a vector field. Furthermore for $p \in M$, it is contained in a single (a_i, b_i) or two. If it is contained in a single one, then $X_p = \lambda_i(p)X_p^i = X_p^i$ (since the partition must sum to one), which is nonzero by definition. Otherwise,

$$X_p = \lambda_i(p)X_p^i + \lambda_{i+1}(p)X_p^{i+1} = \lambda_i(p) \left. \frac{d}{dt} \right|_p + (1 - \lambda_i(p))\tau_i'(p) \left. \frac{d}{dt} \right|_p.$$

This cannot be zero, if it were then

$$\lambda_i(p)(\tau_i'(p) - 1) = \tau_i'(p),$$

But $\lambda_i(p)(\tau_i'(p) - 1) \leq \tau_i'(p) - 1 < \tau_i'(p)$ a contradiction.

5.3 Problem

Let $G = \text{GL}_n(\mathbb{C})$ be the Lie group of complex invertible $n \times n$ matrices. Its Lie group $\mathfrak{g} \cong T_e G$ can be identified with $\text{Mat}_n(\mathbb{C})$.

- (1) Prove an explicit formula for left-invariant vector fields on G .
- (2) Prove an explicit formula for the exponential map $\exp: \mathfrak{g} \rightarrow G$.
- (3) Let $X, Y \in \mathfrak{g}$, show in two ways that $[X, Y] = XY - YX$.
 - (i) Use part (1) and the definition of Lie brackets.
 - (ii) Prove an explicit formula for $\text{Ad}: G \rightarrow \text{Aut}(\mathfrak{g})$, use the fact that $\text{ad} = \text{Ad}_*$ and $\text{ad}_X(Y) = [X, Y]$, as well as part (2).

- (1) We know in general for $v \in T_e G$, it defines the left-invariant vector field $v^L \in \text{Lie}(G)$ given by

$$v_g^L = d(L_g)_e v.$$

So we need to compute the differentials of left multiplication. Recall the identification $\text{Mat}_n(\mathbb{C}) \leftrightarrow T_I G$ by mapping a matrix $(A_j^i) \in \text{Mat}_n(\mathbb{C})$ to

$$(A_j^i) \leftrightarrow A_j^{i,b} \frac{\partial}{\partial x_j^{i,b}}$$

where $A_j^{i,0} = \text{Re}(A_j^i)$ and $A_j^{i,1} = \text{Im}(A_j^i)$.

For a matrix A recall that

$$d(L_A)_I \left(\frac{\partial}{\partial x_j^{i,b}} \Big|_I \right) = \frac{\partial(L_A)_k^{\ell,c}}{\partial x_j^{i,b}}(A) \frac{\partial}{\partial x_k^{\ell,c}} \Big|_A,$$

so we compute the partial derivatives of L_A . Let $(X_j^{i,b})$ be a complex-valued matrix,

$$(L_A X)_k^\ell = (AX)_k^\ell = A_t^\ell X_k^t,$$

And thus

$$(L_A X)_k^{\ell,0} = \text{Re}((AX)_k^\ell) = (A_t^{\ell,0} X_k^{t,0}) - (A_t^{\ell,1} X_k^{t,1})$$

so that

$$\frac{\partial(L_A)_k^{\ell,0}}{\partial x_k^{t,0}} = A_t^{\ell,0}, \quad \frac{\partial(L_A)_k^{\ell,0}}{\partial x_k^{t,1}} = -A_t^{\ell,1}.$$

Similarly

$$(L_A X)_k^{\ell,1} = A_t^{\ell,0} X_k^{t,1} + A_t^{\ell,1} X_k^{t,0}$$

so that

$$\frac{\partial(L_A)_k^{\ell,1}}{\partial x_k^{t,0}} = A_t^{\ell,1}, \quad \frac{\partial(L_A)_k^{\ell,1}}{\partial x_k^{t,1}} = A_t^{\ell,0}.$$

All other partial derivatives are zero.

So we have that

$$d(L_A)_I \left(\frac{\partial}{\partial x_j^{i,0}} \Big|_I \right) = A_i^{\ell,0} \frac{\partial}{\partial x_j^{\ell,0}} \Big|_A + A_i^{\ell,1} \frac{\partial}{\partial x_j^{\ell,1}} \Big|_A,$$

and

$$d(L_A)_I \left(\frac{\partial}{\partial x_j^{i,1}} \Big|_I \right) = -A_i^{\ell,0} \frac{\partial}{\partial x_j^{\ell,0}} \Big|_A + A_i^{\ell,1} \frac{\partial}{\partial x_j^{\ell,1}} \Big|_A.$$

Under the correspondence $\partial/\partial x_j^{i,0} \Big|_I$ is the basis matrix E_{ij} , and $\partial/\partial x_j^{i,1} \Big|_I = iE_{ij}$ (multiplication by the imaginary unit). We see then that

$$d(L_A)_I(E_{ij}) = AE_{ij}, \quad d(L_A)_I(iE_{ij}) = AiE_{ij}$$

under the natural correspondence.

By linearity we see that

$$d(L_A)_I(B) = AB$$

for all matrices B . Thus the left-invariant vector field corresponding to $B \in T_I G$ is

$$B^L|_A = d(L_A)_I(B) = AB.$$

(2) For a matrix A define

$$e^A = \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} \frac{1}{k!} A^k.$$

By submultiplicity of the Frobenius norm, this converges absolutely for all A (as we can compare the series with $|A|^k/k!$ which converges to $e^{|A|}$). We claim that $\exp(A) = e^A$ for all matrices.

To do this, we need to show that for $A \in \mathfrak{g}$, its one-parameter subgroup is given by $\gamma(t) = e^{tA}$. We need to show that $\gamma(t)$ is invertible for all t (so that it lands in G), $\gamma'(t) = A^L|_{\gamma(t)}$ for all t (so it defines the one-parameter subgroup), and $\gamma(0) = I$. The last point is the easiest as it follows from the definition that $e^0 = I$.

For the second point, we need to show

$$\gamma'(t) = A^L|_{\gamma(t)} = \gamma(t)A$$

by our formula for left-invariant vector fields. Note that

$$\gamma(t) = \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} \frac{t^k}{k!} A^k$$

is a power series which converges uniformly in any closed interval, and thus we can differentiate it term by term:

$$\gamma'(t) = \sum_{k=1}^{\infty} \frac{t^{k-1}}{(k-1)!} A^k = \left(\sum_{k=0}^{\infty} \frac{t^k}{k!} A^k \right) A = \gamma(t)A$$

as desired.

Finally to show that $\gamma(t)$ is invertible, we will show that its inverse is $\gamma(-t)$ (not surprising by exponential laws). So define $\sigma(t) = \gamma(t)\gamma(-t)$, we will show that it has zero derivative. By the product rule and what we just showed,

$$\sigma'(t) = \gamma'(t)\gamma(-t) + \gamma(t)\gamma'(-t) = \gamma(t)A\gamma(-t) - \gamma(t)A\gamma(-t) = 0$$

so $\sigma(t)$ is constant. Since $\sigma(0) = \gamma(0)\gamma(0) = I$, we see that $\sigma(t) = I$ for all t and thus $\gamma(t)$ is invertible for all t . Thus $\gamma(t)$ is A^L 's integral flow starting at I , thus the one-parameter subgroup generated by A . Then by definition

$$\exp(A) = \gamma(1) = e^A$$

as desired.

(3)

(i) We recall that

$$[A, B] = [A^L, B^L]_I$$

and for vector fields,

$$[A, B] = \left(A^i \frac{\partial B^j}{\partial x^i} - B^i \frac{\partial A^j}{\partial x^i} \right) \frac{\partial}{\partial x^j}.$$

In our case as we showed,

$$A_X^L = XA = X_k^i A_j^k \frac{\partial}{\partial x_j^i},$$

where we split the real and imaginary parts. Then

$$(A^L)_j^i(X) = X_k^i A_j^k \implies \frac{\partial (A^L)_j^i}{\partial x_k^i} = A_j^k$$

thus

$$[A^L, B^L]_I = \left((A^L)_j^i(I) B_k^j - (B^L)_j^i(I) A_k^j \right) \frac{\partial}{\partial x_k^i} = (A_j^i B_k^j - B_j^i A_k^j) \frac{\partial}{\partial x_k^i}$$

which is $AB - BA$ under the correspondence.

(ii) By naturality of $\exp$, the following diagram commutes

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \mathfrak{g} & \xrightarrow{\quad \text{Ad}_* \quad} & \text{end}(\mathfrak{g}) \\ \exp \downarrow & & \downarrow \exp \\ G & \xrightarrow{\quad \text{Ad} \quad} & \text{Aut}(\mathfrak{g}) \end{array}$$

Since $\text{Aut}(\mathfrak{g})$ is $\text{GL}(\mathfrak{g})$, we already know that $\exp'$ is given by the exponential map defined above:

$$\exp'(\Phi) = \sum_k \frac{1}{k!} \Phi^k, \quad \Phi \in \text{end}(\mathfrak{g}),$$

so we write $\exp$ for $\exp'$ as well. Since $\text{ad} = \text{Ad}_*$ we have

$$\text{Ad}(\exp(A)) = \exp(\text{ad}(A)).$$

By linearity, $\text{ad}(A)$'s one-parameter subgroup is given by $\gamma(t) = \exp(t\text{ad}(A)) = \exp(\text{ad}(tA)) = \text{Ad}(\exp(tA))$. This means that $\gamma'(0) = \text{ad}(A) = [A, \bullet]$, so we want to differentiate $\text{Ad}(\exp(tA))$.

Now we claim that $\text{Ad}(A)B = ABA^{-1}$ for all $A \in G, B \in \mathfrak{g}$. Indeed,

$$\text{Ad}(A) = (R_{A^{-1}})_* \circ (L_A)_*$$

and we showed that $(L_A)_* = d(L_A)_I$ is left multiplication by A , dually $(R_A)_*$ is right multiplication by A . Thus $\text{Ad}(A)B = ABA^{-1}$ as desired.

We know that

$$[A, B] = \text{ad}(A)B = \left(\frac{d}{dt} \Big|_{t=0} \text{Ad}(\exp(tA)) \right) B = \frac{d}{dt} \Big|_{t=0} (\text{Ad}(\exp(tA))B),$$

and since $\exp(A)^{-1} = \exp(-A)$,

$$\text{Ad}(\exp(tA))B = \exp(tA)B\exp(-tA)$$

so that

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{d}{dt} \Big|_{t=0} \text{Ad}(\exp(tA))B &= \left(\frac{d}{dt} \Big|_{t=0} \exp(tA) \right) B \exp(0) + \exp(0)B \left(\frac{d}{dt} \Big|_{t=0} \exp(-tA) \right) \\ &= AB - BA, \end{aligned}$$

where the last equality is because $\exp(tA)$ is the one-parameter subgroup generated by A . So we have shown

$$[A, B] = AB - BA$$

as desired.

5.4 Problem

Consider the Lie group $G = U_n$ of complex unitary $n \times n$ matrices and its Lie algebra $\mathfrak{u}_n$. In a

previous homework we showed a natural identification $\mathfrak{u}_n \cong T_e U_n$ with the space of skew-Hermitian matrices ($M^\dagger = -M$).

- (1) Repeat the previous problem for G .
- (2) Define an inner product on $T_e U_n$ by

$$g_e(X, Y) = \operatorname{Re} \operatorname{tr}(X^\dagger Y).$$

Show that g_e extends to a bi-invariant metric g on U_n .

- (3) Verify that $g([X, Y], Z) = -g(Y, [X, Z])$ for $X, Y, Z \in \mathfrak{u}_n$.

- (1) U_n is an embedded Lie subgroup of $\operatorname{GL}_n(\mathbb{C})$ as we showed in the previous homework. Thus for $U \in U_n$, $L_U: U_n \rightarrow U_n$ is the restriction of $L_U: \operatorname{GL}_n(\mathbb{C}) \rightarrow \operatorname{GL}_n(\mathbb{C})$ and thus dL_U is given by the same formula as for $\operatorname{GL}_n(\mathbb{C})$. That is, left-multiplication by U . So left-invariant vector fields are of the form

$$M_U^L = UM, \quad U \in U_n, M \in \mathfrak{u}_n.$$

Since U_n is a Lie subgroup, its exponential is the restriction of that of $\operatorname{GL}_n(\mathbb{C})$ so it is given by the same formula (matrix exponentiation), and the Lie bracket is as well.

- (2) If we have an inner product $g_e \bullet, \bullet$ on $\mathfrak{g}$ then we showed it extends to a metric on G by

$$g(X, Y) = g_e(X_e, Y_e).$$

This is right-invariant when it is invariant under Ad . This is because for $X \in \mathfrak{u}_n$ and $U \in U_n$ we have $\operatorname{Ad}(U)X = (R_{U^{-1}})_*(L_U)_*X = (R_{U^{-1}})X$ by left-invariance. Thus for $X, Y \in \mathfrak{u}_n$,

$$\begin{aligned} ((R_{U^{-1}})^*g)_V(X_V, Y_V) &= g_{VU^{-1}}(((R_{U^{-1}})_*X)_{VU^{-1}}, ((R_{U^{-1}})_*Y)_{VU^{-1}}) \\ &= g_{VU^{-1}}((\operatorname{Ad}(U)X)_{VU^{-1}}, (\operatorname{Ad}(U)Y)_{VU^{-1}}) = g_I(\operatorname{Ad}(U)X, \operatorname{Ad}(U)Y). \end{aligned}$$

The last equality is due to how we extended g_e : $g_U(X_U, Y_U) = g_e(X_e, Y_e)$. So if g_e is Ad -invariant then

$$((R_{U^{-1}})^*g)_V(X_V, Y_V) = g_I(X, Y) = g_V(X_V, Y_V),$$

so that g is right-invariant.

Again Ad on U_n is the restriction of Ad on $\operatorname{GL}_n(\mathbb{C})$ so $\operatorname{Ad}(U)X = UXU^{-1} = UXU^\dagger$ since U is unitary. Thus

$$g_I(\operatorname{Ad}(U)X, \operatorname{Ad}(U)Y) = g_I(UXU^\dagger, UYU^\dagger) = \operatorname{Re} \operatorname{tr}((UXU^\dagger)^\dagger (UYU^\dagger)) = \operatorname{Re} \operatorname{tr}(UX^\dagger YU^\dagger).$$

Permuting the matrices in the trace, this is equal to

$$= \operatorname{Re} \operatorname{tr}(U^\dagger U X^\dagger Y) = \operatorname{Re} \operatorname{tr}(X^\dagger Y) = g_I(X, Y).$$

So g_I is Ad -invariant as desired.

For completeness, g_I is an inner product because $(X, Y) \mapsto \operatorname{tr}(X^\dagger Y)$ is a complex inner product (the Frobenius inner product), and taking the real part of a complex inner product is a real inner product.

- (3) We compute directly:

$$g_I([X, Y], Z) = \operatorname{Re} \operatorname{tr}((XY - YX)^\dagger Z) = \operatorname{Re} \operatorname{tr}(Y^\dagger X^\dagger Z) - \operatorname{Re} \operatorname{tr}(X^\dagger Y^\dagger Z),$$

since X, Y are skew-Hermitian this is equal to

$$g_I([X, Y], Z) = \operatorname{Re} \operatorname{tr}(YXZ) - \operatorname{Re} \operatorname{tr}(XYZ).$$

And

$$g_I(Y, [X, Z]) = \operatorname{Re} \operatorname{tr}(Y^\dagger(XZ - ZX)) = -\operatorname{Re} \operatorname{tr}(YXZ - YZX) = -(\operatorname{Re} \operatorname{tr}(YXZ) - \operatorname{Re} \operatorname{tr}(YZX))$$

permuting cyclicly the product in the last trace gives us

$$g_I(Y, [X, Z]) = -(\operatorname{Re} \operatorname{tr}(YXZ) - \operatorname{Re} \operatorname{tr}(XYZ)) = -g_I([X, Y], Z)$$

as desired.

5.5 Problem

Let $\operatorname{SL}_n(\mathbb{R})$ denote the group of $n \times n$ real matrices with unit determinant. We show that it is a Lie group of dimension $n^2 - 1$ with Lie algebra $\mathfrak{sl}_n$, $n \times n$ real matrices with zero trace.

We also define SU_n to be the group of $n \times n$ unitary matrices with unit determinant. We show that it is a Lie group with Lie algebra $\mathfrak{su}_n$, $n \times n$ skew-Hermitian matrices of trace 0.

- (1) Let $F: \operatorname{Mat}_n(\mathbb{R}) \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ be given by taking the determinant. Thus for $A \in \operatorname{Mat}_n(\mathbb{R})$, its differential $dF_A: \operatorname{Mat}_n(\mathbb{R}) \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ is a linear map. Show that

$$dF_A(B) = \operatorname{tr}(\operatorname{adj}(A)B)$$

where $\operatorname{adj}(A)$ is the adjugate of A .

- (2) Use the previous point to show that 1 is a regular value of $\det$. Conclude that $\operatorname{SL}_n(\mathbb{R})$ is a smooth manifold of dimension $n^2 - 1$ and $T_2\operatorname{SL}_n(\mathbb{R}) = \mathfrak{sl}_n(\mathbb{R})$.
- (3) Prove that group multiplication and inversion on $\operatorname{SL}_n(\mathbb{R})$ are smooth, so that $\operatorname{SL}_n(\mathbb{R})$ is a Lie group.
- (4) Identify S^1 with the unit circle in $\mathbb{C}$, so a Lie group. Define the group morphism $h: U_n \rightarrow S^1$ by $h(U) = \det U$. Show that h is smooth and $\operatorname{id} \in U_n$ is a regular point of h .
- (5) Use the fact that h is a homomorphism to show that it is a submersion.
- (6) Conclude that SU_n is a Lie group.
- (7) Let $\iota: U_n \hookrightarrow \operatorname{Mat}_n(\mathbb{C})$ be the inclusion. Show that the composition

$$T_I U_n \xrightarrow{d\iota_I} T_I \operatorname{Mat}_n(\mathbb{C}) \xrightarrow{\zeta} \operatorname{Mat}_n(\mathbb{C})$$

carries $T_I \operatorname{SU}_n \subseteq T_I U_n$ to $\mathfrak{su}_n \subseteq \mathfrak{u}_n$, where ζ maps $[\gamma]$ to $\gamma'(0)$.

- (1) We know that

$$dF_A \left(\left. \frac{\partial}{\partial x_j^i} \right|_A \right) = \frac{\partial F}{\partial x_j^i}(A) \frac{d}{dt}.$$

$\partial/\partial x_j^i|_A$ corresponds to the standard basis matrix E_j^i (zero except at the (i, j) coordinate), so we want to show that this is equal to

$$dF_A(E_j^i) = \frac{\partial F}{\partial x_j^i}(A) \frac{d}{dt} = \operatorname{tr}(\operatorname{adj}(A)E_j^i) \frac{d}{dt},$$

and then by linearity we get the result for all B , not just E_j^i . So we want to show that

$$\frac{\partial F}{\partial x_j^i}(A) = \text{tr}(\text{adj}(A)E_j^i) = (\text{adj}(A)E_j^i)_k^k = \text{adj}(A)_i^j = (-1)^{i+j} \det(A_{ij})$$

where A_{ij} is the minor obtained by removing the i th row and j th column of A .

For $X = (x_j^i)$,

$$F(X) = \sum_{\sigma \in S_n} \text{sgn} \sigma \prod_{i=1}^n x_{\sigma(i)}^i,$$

so

$$\frac{\partial F}{\partial x_j^i} = \sum_{\sigma(i)=j} \text{sgn} \sigma \prod_{k \neq i} x_{\sigma(k)}^k.$$

Notice that

$$\frac{\partial F}{\partial x_j^i}(A) = \sum_{\sigma(i)=j} \text{sgn} \sigma \prod_{k \neq i} a_{\sigma(k)}^k = (-1)^{i+j} \det(A_{ij})$$

as desired, since the permutations run over $\sigma \in S_{n-1}$ (identified with the subset of S_n where $\sigma(i) = j$, and this identification changes the sign by $(-1)^{i+j}$).

- (2) If $F(A) = 1$, meaning $\det(A) = 1$, then A is invertible and $\text{adj}(A) = A^{-1}$. Thus

$$dF_A(A) = \text{tr}(\text{adj}(A)A) = \text{tr}(I) = n \neq 0.$$

This means that dF_A is a nonzero linear functional, and thus surjective (as its codomain is one-dimensional). In other words, A is a regular point of F , so 1 is a regular value.

Since $\text{SL}_n(\mathbb{R}) = F^{-1}(1)$, by the regular level set theorem this means $\text{SL}_n(\mathbb{R})$ is an embedded smooth submanifold of $\text{Mat}_n(\mathbb{R})$, whose codimension is $\dim \mathbb{R} = 1$. Thus its dimension is $\dim \text{SL}_n(\mathbb{R}) = \dim \text{Mat}_n(\mathbb{R}) - 1 = n^2 - 1$.

Finally we also know that $T_I \text{SL}_n(\mathbb{R}) = \ker dF_I$. This is because for a regular level set $F^{-1}q$, its dimension equals $\ker dF_p$ (since dF_p is surjective, the kernel has codimension equal to the dimension of its codomain), and F is constant on $F^{-1}q$ so $dF_p = 0$ on the level set, so $T_p F^{-1}q$ is contained in the kernel. Their dimensions are equal, so they are equal.

Since $dF_I(B) = \text{tr}(\text{adj}(I)^{-1}B) = \text{tr}(B)$, its kernel is all the matrices B of zero trace. Thus $T_I \text{SL}_n(\mathbb{R}) = \mathfrak{sl}_n(\mathbb{R})$ as desired.

- (3) $\text{SL}_n(\mathbb{R})$ is a subgroup of $\text{GL}_n(\mathbb{R})$ and an embedded submanifold of $\text{Mat}_n(\mathbb{R})$. Thus it is embedded in $\text{GL}_n(\mathbb{R})$ as well, and multiplication and inversion in $\text{GL}_n(\mathbb{R})$ restrict to $\text{SL}_n(\mathbb{R})$. We showed in a previous homework that we can restrict both the domain and codomain of a smooth function to embedded submanifolds, so doing this for multiplication and inversion (restricting the smooth maps of $\text{GL}_n(\mathbb{R})$ to $\text{SL}_n(\mathbb{R})$) shows that multiplication and inversion of $\text{SL}_n(\mathbb{R})$ is smooth.
- (4) S^1 is embedded in $\mathbb{C}$, and U_n in $\text{Mat}_n(\mathbb{C})$. The map $\det: \text{Mat}_n(\mathbb{C}) \rightarrow \mathbb{C}$ is smooth, and we can restrict it to the embedded submanifolds (on both the domain and codomain) $U_n \subseteq \text{Mat}_n(\mathbb{C})$ and $S^1 \subseteq \mathbb{C}$. Thus $\det: U_n \rightarrow S^1$ is smooth.

A similar computation as in part (1) shows that

$$dh_I(A) = \text{tr}(\text{adj}(I)^{-1}A) = \text{tr}(A).$$

Since $T_I U_n \cong \mathfrak{u}_n$, the space of matrices skew-Hermitian matrices, taking $A = iI$ we see that $dh_I(A)$ is nonzero. Since S^1 is one-dimensional, this means that dh_I has full-rank and thus I is a regular point.

- (5) h is a group homomorphism between Lie groups (by multiplicity of the determinant), and thus has constant rank. Since h has rank 1 at I , it has rank 1 everywhere. Since $\dim S^1 = 1$, this means that h is a submersion.

- (6) $SU_n = h^{-1}(1)$ is a regular level set (since h is a submersion, every level set is regular), and thus an embedded submanifold of U_n . It is also a subgroup of U_n , and since we can restrict smooth functions to embedded submanifolds, restricting multiplication and inversion of U_n to SU_n shows that they are smooth, so it is a Lie group.
- (7) SU_n 's codimension is equal to the rank of h , so 1. Thus

$$\dim SU_n = \dim U_n - 1 = n^2 - 1.$$

The dimension of $\mathfrak{su}_n$ is also $n^2 - 1$: a skew-Hermitian matrix is determined by its values on its upper triangle, with imaginary values on its diagonal. Requiring that its trace be zero gives us $n - 1$ choices of the diagonal, so

$$\dim \mathfrak{su}_n = \frac{n^2 - n}{2} \cdot 2 + (n - 1) = n^2 - 1,$$

where we multiply the first term by 2 since each element of the upper triangle is complex (real + imaginary parts). Explicitly, a basis for $\mathfrak{su}_n$ is given by

$$\left\{ E_j^i - E_i^j, iE_j^i + iE_j^i \mid i > j \right\} \cup \left\{ iE_i^i - iE_n^n \mid i < n \right\}.$$

Since $\zeta \circ d\iota_I$ is a composition of injections, it is an injection ($d\iota_I$ is an injection since U_n is embedded and thus ι is an immersion). So we need only show that it carries $T_I SU_n$ into $\mathfrak{su}_n$, and then considering dimensions this shows that the image of $T_I SU_n$ is equal to $\mathfrak{su}_n$.

Let $\gamma: (-\varepsilon, \varepsilon) \rightarrow SU_n$ be a curve starting at I . Then

$$\zeta \circ d\iota_I[\gamma] = \zeta[\iota \circ \gamma] = (\iota \circ \gamma)'(0).$$

So we identify γ with $\iota \circ \gamma$ and view it as a curve into $\text{Mat}_n(\mathbb{C})$ with values in SU_n (meaning $\gamma(t)$ is unitary with unit determinant for all t). We already showed that $\gamma'(0) \in \mathfrak{u}_n$ in a previous homework, so we need only show that $\text{tr} \gamma'(0) = 0$.

We know that $\det \gamma(t) = 1$, and thus

$$0 = \left. \frac{d}{dt} \right|_{t=0} \det \gamma(t) = d \det_{\gamma(0)} \gamma'(0) = d \det_I(\gamma'(0)).$$

We showed above that this is equal to

$$= \text{tr}(\text{adj}(I)\gamma'(0)) = \text{tr}(\gamma'(0)),$$

so $\gamma'(0)$ has trace zero, as desired.